THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

2021W2 UBC Individual TA Report for ECON 601 L1A - Microeconomics II (Bufang Duan)

Project Title: **2021W2 UBC TA SEI Surveys**

Course Audience: **23**
Responses Received: **8**
Response Ratio: **35%**

Report Comments

Recommended Minimum Response Rates

Class Size	Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin
< 10	75%
11 - 19	65%
20 - 34	55%
35 - 49	40%
50 - 74	35%
75 - 99	25%
100 - 149	20%
150 - 299	15%
300 - 499	10%
> 500	5%

Creation Date: **Thursday, May 26, 2022**

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TA Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	DI
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	23	8	0	0	0	2	6	0	4.8	0.2
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA presented information clearly.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	23	8	0	0	0	2	6	0	4.8	0.2
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	23	8	0	1	1	0	6	0	4.8	0.5
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	23	8	0	0	1	0	7	0	4.9	0.2
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	23	8	0	0	1	0	7	0	4.9	0.2

Question	%Favourable
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	100%
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	100%
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	100%
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	100%
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	100%
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	100%
The TA presented information clearly.	100%
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	100%
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	100%
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	100%
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	75%
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	100%
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	88%
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	88%

How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very Good	N/A	IM	DI
23	8	0	0	0	1	7	0	4.9	0.1

Question	%Favourable
How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?	100%

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?		
Options	Count	Percentage
None	0	0%
Less than 25%	0	0%
25-50%	0	0%
51-75%	1	13%
Greater than 75%	7	88%

Which, if any, of the following did your Teaching Assistant do? (Please mark each element that is appropriate)

Options	Count
Led discussion-tutorial groups	5
Held office hours	8
marked examination(s)	6
marked essay(s)-assignment(s)	5
gave classroom lectures	6
conducted labs	0
responded to email	7
Respondent(s)	8

Considering everything, how would you rate this course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very good	N/A	IM	DI
23	8	0	0	0	2	6	0	4.8	0.2

Question	%Favourable
Considering everything, how would you rate this course?	100%

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of your teaching assistant's (TA's) teaching, attitudes to students, class atmosphere, or any other matters affecting the quality of instruction that you consider worthy of note.

Comments
It would have been helpful if assignments were graded, since often we used different approaches and there was no way to know whether or not they were correct since none of the problem sets were checked
William was an amazing TA! My understanding of the concepts improved because of his office hours and tutorials. He was very approachable and willing to answer questions and help us out. He was also very responsive through email and overall contributed immensely to my learning during the course. I really enjoyed the auction games we played during class. I thought that was a very practical way of applying the concepts we were learning. I also appreciated the review sessions he held during the midterm and final. It was very supportive of him to do that. Overall, William understands the material well, he explains well, patiently addresses questions and he is very responsive through email and is open to meeting during office hours.
William's sessions were essential to reinforce the concepts of the course. His commitment to the group was remarkable.
Always willing to help and takes all questions seriously. Great TA.

Explanatory Note

Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who rated the instructor a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree).

Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Experience of Instruction (SEI) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). While the mean may be used as a measure of central tendency for such data, it is not an appropriate or accurate representation of SEI data (cf. Stark & Freishtat, 2014). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median. As a result, we have been reporting the mean and the median for the last several years. After considerable thought and data modeling, we now believe that the interpolated median is the best representation of the data, since it takes the frequency distribution into account.

Consider the following example from 2015W, the two course sections have identical mean (3.8). However, the instructor in section 2 received 77% favourable (4-5) ratings, compared to 53% for the instructor in section 1. The Interpolated median values of (3.7 and 4.2), much better reflects the distribution of the scores above and below their respective median. Furthermore, the interpolated median is better correlated with percent favourable rating; such that an interpolated median of 3.5 on a Likert scale of 1 to 5, corresponds to 50% favourable rating.

Frequency Distribution

Response for University Module Item	Section 1	Section 2
5 = Strongly agree	5	5
4 = Agree	3	5
3 = Neither agree nor disagree	6	0
2 = Disagree	1	2
1 = Strongly disagree	0	1
Mean	3.8	3.8
Median	4.0	4.0

Interpolated Median	3.7	4.2
Percent favourable rating	53%	77%

Dispersion Index

The dispersion index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all respondents in the section rated their experience of instruction the same. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the respondents are split evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEI data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the minimum recommended response rate.